

DESIGN SUPPORT DOCUMENT – CODECAMPUS

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN C

27 September 2026

1. Introduction

This document explains how CodeCampus’s redesigned checkout, button interactions, and course-completion experience are supported by the group’s UX research, how the design applies the Peak-End Rule, and how it satisfies the client’s stated need.

The client’s brief for Group Design C was explicit:

“I see there are a lot of websites out there that do the same thing as ours, but theirs are just so... bland. I need ours to pop! Whether it’s them checking out a course, pushing a button, or finishing a course, something needs to stand out!”

To ground this redesign in evidence rather than assumption, each group member independently evaluated an existing e-learning platform (Khan Academy, Udemy and Coursera) using a shortened User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S). The evaluation focused on key moments that the Peak-End Rule identifies as most influential: the most intense emotional peaks during the journey and the final moment of the experience (Schrepp, Hinderks & Thomaschewski, 2017). This document synthesises those three reports into a single set of design guidelines and shows

how CodeCampus's checkout, interactive buttons, and course-completion screens put them into practice.

2. Persona

Thabo M., the Career-Switching Builder

"I don't have hours to waste. When I finally finish something or buy a course, I want to feel it — not just get a quiet confirmation page."

Key goal (stated as an outcome):

Feel a clear, memorable sense of progress and achievement when purchasing, interacting with, or completing a course, so that the experience stands out from the bland platforms he has used before

Behaviour:

- Browses and decides in short bursts.
- Notices and remembers moments of celebration or friction more than the middle of the journey.
- Expects buttons and final screens to give immediate, positive feedback.

Must:

- Make the checkout success moment feel rewarding and unmistakable.
- Give every important button a clear, satisfying response.
- Turn course completion into a genuine peak experience (certificate, clear next steps).

Mustn't:

- Deliver a quiet, text-only confirmation after payment or completion.
- Leave the user wondering whether an action registered.

- End the journey on a bland or anticlimactic note.

3. Task Model

Goal:

Complete a meaningful learning action (purchase, mark a lesson complete, or finish a course) and leave with a strong positive memory of that moment.

Order of tasks:

- Browse / select a course.
- Add to cart and complete checkout.
- Interact with lesson buttons (“Mark lesson complete”).
- Reach the final lesson and finish the course.
- Experience the completion celebration and decide next action (download certificate, start another course, return to dashboard).

Evaluation type:

Primarily a Peak-End evaluation — the emotional intensity of the checkout success and course-completion screens, plus the micro-peaks created by button feedback, determine how the whole experience is remembered.

4. User Journey

Phase	What Thabo does	Emotion
1. Discover	Lands on the catalogue after logging in, with about 15 minutes before his next commitment.	Slightly impatient
2. Scan	Scrolls the list; titles, levels and durations are visible without opening each course.	Relieved

3. Compare	Uses the sort control to bring “Beginner” Python courses to the top of the list.	In control
4. Decide	Opens a course, reads the short description, and clicks “Start Course.”	Confident

5. Synthesis of UX Research

All three reference platforms (Khan Academy, Udemy, Coursera) use a card or tile-based catalogue, the exact pattern the client wants to move away from. A data limitation should be noted here: Khan Academy's report used the full 8-criteria UEQ-S, while the Udemy and Coursera reports used a 5-criteria subset (Boring-Exciting, Conventional-Innovative, Usual-Modern, Inefficient-Efficient, Not Interesting-Interesting). The table below compares the five criteria all three reports have in common.

Criterion	Khan Academy	Udemy	Coursera	Cross-site average
Boring – Exciting	4.3	4.7	4.7	4.57
Conventional – Innovative	3.7	4.7	4.7	4.37
Usual – Modern	4.7	5.3	5.7	5.23
Not Interesting – Interesting	4.7	4.7	4.7	4.70
Inefficient – Efficient	5.3	5.7	5.7	5.57

Key patterns:

- Exciting and Interesting scores sit only modestly above neutral (4.3–4.7) across all three sites. Participants repeatedly described the final moments as functional but bland.
- 83–92 % of participants across the three reports explicitly asked for a more celebratory course-completion experience.

- Progress indicators and clear feedback were valued (Khan Academy's ticks and progress bar scored highly), but the absence of a strong emotional peak at the very end left the overall memory weaker than it could be.
- Checkout flows were rated efficient, yet none created a memorable "you're in" moment.

The research therefore confirms the client's observation: the middle of the experience can be solid, but without deliberate peaks at checkout, button interaction, and especially course completion, the platforms feel bland.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

Combining the independent recommendations from the three reports:

- Treat checkout success and course completion as deliberate Peak moments - use scale, colour, motion (confetti), and a clear certificate or confirmation that the user will remember.
- Give every primary action button immediate, positive visual feedback so that each "push" itself becomes a small peak.
- Make the final screen of a course the emotional high point of the entire journey (large heading, certificate, stats, clear next steps).
- Keep secondary information and navigation available but visually subordinate so they do not dilute the peak.
- Do not rely on novelty alone; the celebration must feel earned and specific to the user's achievement.

7. Peak-End Rule Application

The Peak-End Rule states that people judge an experience largely by its most intense moment (the peak) and by how it ends, rather than by the average of every moment (Kahneman et al., referenced in Wong, 2026).

CodeCampus applies this principle in three concrete places the client identified:

1. **Checkout:** After payment the user is taken to a full screen “You’re in!” success state with confetti, a large checkmark, order confirmation, and two clear next actions. This creates a strong positive peak now of commitment.
2. **Button interactions:** “Mark lesson complete” and similar primary buttons produce an immediate visual response (toast notification “Nice work”, progress bar update, checkmark animation). Each press becomes a small, satisfying peak.
3. **Course completion:** The final screen is designed as the highest peak of the journey: large celebratory heading, animated confetti, personalised certificate, key stats (lessons done, duration, track), and prominent actions (Download certificate, go to my dashboard, Browse more courses). The experience deliberately ends on this high note.

8. Design Walkthrough

8.1 Checkout Success

After the user completes payment they see a centred card with a large dark checkmark, the message “You’re in!”, confetti, the purchased course, and two high-contrast buttons. The moment is unmistakable and positive.

8.2 Lesson Interaction

On the lesson page the primary “Mark lesson complete” button is large and high contrast. Clicking it triggers an immediate “Nice work” toast and updates the progress bar and sidebar checkmarks, giving continuous micro-peaks.

8.3 Course Completion

When the final lesson is marked complete the user is taken to a dedicated celebration page:

- Large gold circle and “COURSE COMPLETE” label
- Bold heading “You finished [Course Name]!”
- Personalised certificate with name, course title and date
- Key stats (lessons, hours, track)
- Confetti animation
- Clear primary and secondary actions

This screen is the intentional End peak of the entire learning journey.

9. How the Design Satisfies the Client's Need

The client asked for the product to “pop” at three specific moments. CodeCampus delivers exactly that:

- **Checking out a course:** full celebratory success screen instead of a quiet confirmation.
- **Pushing a button:** immediate visual and textual feedback on every primary action.
- **Finishing a course:** a designed peak experience with certificate, confetti, stats and clear next steps.

10. Conclusion

The three UX evaluations conducted for this deliverable all point to the same conclusion: card-based catalogues can look modern, but the more sub-targets they pack into a single card, the less efficient they are perceived to be, a direct, measurable illustration of Fitts's Law. CodeCampus's

list-based catalogue and course detail page apply that finding directly, using large, consistently spaced, predictably positioned targets to satisfy both the client's explicit request and the usability principle behind it.

11. References

Kahneman, D. et al. (referenced in Wong, Y., 2026). Peak-End Rule.

Schrepp, M., Hinderks, A. and Thomaschewski, J., 2017. Design and evaluation of a short version of the user experience questionnaire (UEQ-S). *International Journal of Interaction Multimedia and Artificial Intelligence*, 4(6), pp.103-108.

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